

I. a)  $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$  is invertible; its inverse is  $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$

$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$  is invertible; its inverse is  $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$

$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$  is not invertible, since it is not injective.

b) Since linear transformations are in bijection with matrices (once we fix bases in the domain and codomain), it suffices to count distinct  $2 \times 2$  matrices with entries in  $\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z}$ . So there are  $5^4 = 625$ .

Invertible matrices correspond to linear transformations that are isomorphisms. In particular, they map a basis to a basis. So a matrix is invertible if its columns form a basis (for the codomain). So this problem is closely related to Supp I from last week. There are 480 ordered bases for  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^2$  (240 unordered) so there are 480 invertible matrices in  $M_{2 \times 2}^{\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z}}$ .

$$480 = 24 \times 20$$

$\nwarrow$   $\nearrow$   
# nonzero vectors in  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^2$       # vectors in  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^2$  that are not scalar multiples of the first vector.

II. Every subspace has a dimension, at most the dimension of the whole space, and at least 0.

There is always a unique subspace of the top dimension (the whole space) and a unique subspace of dimension 0.

How can we count subspaces for the other dimensions in between? (Assuming we are working over a finite field, so that the count is finite.)

The big idea is to overcount, and then divide away the overcounting.

$$\#(k\text{-dimensional subspaces}) = \frac{\#(\text{ordered } \overset{k\text{-tuples}}{\text{bases}} \text{ that yield a } k\text{-dimensional subspace})}{\#(\text{ordered bases that yield the same } k\text{-dimensional subspace})}$$

Let's see an example.

To count 1-dimensional subspaces of  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^2$ , first count how many ordered ~~bases~~<sup>1-tuples</sup> there are that yield 1-dimensional subspace.

Any non-zero vector  $v$  in  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^2$  is a basis for a 1-dimensional subspace. Because  $\text{span}\{v\}$  is a 1-dimensional subspace, and  $v$  by itself is a basis for it.

So our numerator is  $5^2 - 1 = 24$ .  
total vectors in  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^2$       the zero vector.

But we are overcounting:  $\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$  and  $\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$  and  $\begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$  and  $\begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$  each yield the same line (1-dim subspace).

The span of each is the same.

This same thing happens for each 1-dim subspace: it contains 4 non-zero vectors, each of which is a basis for it.

So our denominator is 4, and  $\#(1\text{-dim subspaces of } (\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^2)$   
$$= \frac{24}{4} = 6.$$

So  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^2$  contains  $1 + 6 + 1 = 8$  subspaces in total.

What about  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^3$ ? It has 1 3-dim subspace and 1 0-dim subspace. What about 1-dim?

Again, each non-zero vector determines a 1-dim subspace, and each 1-dim subspace is determined by  $5 - 1 = 4$  vectors. So we have  $\frac{5^3 - 1}{4} = \frac{124}{4} = 31$   
non-zero vectors      # vectors yielding the same line

And now 2-dim subspaces of  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^3$ :

We want to count the number of linearly independent <sup>ordered</sup> pairs of vectors in  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^3$ . Such a pair spans a 2-dim subspace, and so the pair is an ordered basis for this subspace. (linearly independent + spans). This count is our numerator.

For the first vector, it just has to be non-zero, so  $5^3 - 1 = 124$  choices.

The second vector in the pair has to be linearly independent from the first, and so it just has to be not a scalar multiple of the first. So  $5^3 - 5$  choices.

So our numerator is  $(5^3 - 1)(5^3 - 5)$ .

For the denominator: how many <sup>ordered</sup> bases does a 2-dim subspace have? Well, a 2-dim subspace is isomorphic to  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^2$ ! So it has  $24 \times 20 = 480$  ordered bases  $(= (5^2 - 1)(5^2 - 5))$

So the number of 2-dim subspaces of  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^3$  is

$$\frac{(5^3 - 1)(5^3 - 5)}{(5^2 - 1)(5^2 - 5)} = \boxed{31}$$

So the total # of subspaces of  $(\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^3$  is  $1 + 31 + 31 + 1 = \boxed{64}$

What about counting subspaces of  $(\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^n$ ?

For the  $k$ -dimensional subspaces ( $0 \leq k \leq n$ ), we do the count in a similar fashion.

~~The~~ We count linearly independent <sup>ordered</sup>  $k$ -tuples, where the pool of vectors gets smaller at each stage (because we can't pick a vector that belongs to the span of the set we've built so far). So at first the pool has  $p^n - 1$  vectors (everything except the zero vector). Then everything except the vectors in the span so far:  $p^n - p$ ,  $p^n - p^2$ , ...,  $p^n - p^{n-k+1}$

$\uparrow$  not in the 1-dim subspace so far       $\uparrow$  not in the 2-dim subspace so far       $\uparrow$  not in the  $(k-1)$ -dim subspace so far

So the numerator is  $(p^n - 1)(p^n - p^1) \cdots (p^n - p^{n-k+1})$

The denominator is the number of <sup>ordered</sup> bases for a  $k$ -dimensional subspace, which is the same (by isomorphism!) as the number of ordered bases for  $(\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^k$ :  $(p^k - 1)(p^k - p)(p^k - p^2) \cdots (p^k - p^{k-1})$

So the number of  $k$ -dimensional subspaces is

$$\prod_{i=0}^{k-1} \frac{(p^n - p^i)}{(p^k - p^i)}$$

And the total number of subspaces of

$$(\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^n$$

is

$$\sum_{k=0}^n \prod_{i=0}^{k-1} \frac{p^n - p^i}{p^k - p^i}.$$



1.7.5

of  $M_{4 \times 4}^{\mathbb{R}}$

A subspace that contains all upper triangular matrices and all symmetric matrices must also contain any matrix that can be written as a linear combination of such matrices. (Since subspaces are closed under taking linear combinations)

But here is a basis for  $M_{4 \times 4}^{\mathbb{R}}$  containing only upper triangular and symmetric matrices!

upper triangular

symmetric

So the smallest subspace containing these two subspaces is the whole space  $M_{4 \times 4}^{\mathbb{R}}$ .

### 1.7.5 (cont.)

The largest subspace of  $M_{4 \times 4}^{\mathbb{R}}$  that is contained in both of the subspaces (upper triangular and symmetric) is the subspace of diagonal matrices, that is, those of the form  ~~$\begin{pmatrix} a & b & c & d \\ 0 & a & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & b & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & c \end{pmatrix}$~~   $\begin{pmatrix} a & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & b & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & c & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & d \end{pmatrix}$ .

To see this, first note that by 1.7.1, the intersection of two subspaces is a subspace. So the largest possible subspace that sits inside of both upper triangular matrices and symmetric matrices is their intersection.

If a matrix is upper triangular, by definition we have that these 6 entries are 0:

$$\begin{pmatrix} - & - & - & - \\ 0 & - & - & - \\ 0 & 0 & - & - \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & - \end{pmatrix}.$$

If the matrix is also symmetric, the 6 strictly upper triangular entries are then also forced to be 0:  $\begin{pmatrix} - & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & - & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & - & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & - \end{pmatrix}$ . The remaining

entries are free to be arbitrary. We see that the intersection is exactly the diagonal matrices in  $M_{4 \times 4}^{\mathbb{R}}$ .



III. The first system is homogeneous.  
 Its corresponding matrix (in  $M_{3 \times 4}^{\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z}}$ ) is

$$\begin{pmatrix} 2 & 3 & 1 & 1 \\ 3 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 & 3 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

Which we now row reduce to RREF.

(This is only a solution for the first system.)

$$\begin{array}{l} 3R1 \\ \rightarrow \end{array} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 & 3 & 3 \\ 3 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 & 3 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{2R2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 & 3 & 3 \\ 1 & 2 & 2 & 2 \\ 1 & 3 & 3 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{\begin{array}{l} R2-R1 \\ (R2+4R1) \end{array}} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 & 3 & 3 \\ 0 & 3 & 4 & 4 \\ 1 & 3 & 3 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\xrightarrow{R3-R1} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 & 3 & 3 \\ 0 & 3 & 4 & 4 \\ 0 & 4 & 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{2R2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 & 3 & 3 \\ 0 & 1 & 3 & 3 \\ 0 & 4 & 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{4R3} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 & 3 & 3 \\ 0 & 1 & 3 & 3 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\xrightarrow{R2 \leftrightarrow R3} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 & 3 & 3 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 3 & 3 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{R3-R2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 & 3 & 3 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 & 4 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{3R3} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 & 3 & 3 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\xrightarrow{R2-3R3} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 & 3 & 3 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{R1-3R3} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow{R1+R2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 4 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \quad \boxed{\text{RREF}}$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \\ z \\ w \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -4w \\ -2w \\ -2w \\ w \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1w \\ 3w \\ 3w \\ 1w \end{pmatrix} = w \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \\ 3 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

vector form

check:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 2 & 3 & 1 & 1 \\ 3 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 & 3 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \\ 3 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2+4+3+1 \\ 3+3+3+1 \\ 1+9+9+1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

NOTE:

$$\text{RREF over } \mathbb{Q}: \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 1/4 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1/8 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1/8 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\text{V } P_3 \cong \mathbb{R}^4$$

Let  $\begin{pmatrix} a \\ b \\ c \\ d \end{pmatrix}$  represent the polynomial  $ax^3+bx^2+cx+d$ .

Its derivative is  $3ax^2+2bx+c$ , or  $\begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 3a \\ 2b \\ c \end{pmatrix}$ .

If these are equal when  $x=0$ ,

then we have  $a \cdot 0^3 + b \cdot 0^2 + c \cdot 0 + d = 3a \cdot 0^2 + 2b \cdot 0 + c$

$$\text{or } d=c.$$

If these are equal when  $x=1$ , we have

$$a \cdot 1^3 + b \cdot 1^2 + c \cdot 1 + d = 3a \cdot 1 + 2b \cdot 1 + c,$$

$$\text{that is, } a + b + c + d = 3a + 2b + c$$

$$\text{that is, } 2a + b - d = 0.$$

So the constraints on the polynomial  $p(x)$  yield the system of linear equations:

$$\begin{aligned} 2a + b - d &= 0 \\ c - d &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

In RREF, this is  $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & \frac{1}{2} & 0 & -\frac{1}{2} \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$ .

$$\begin{aligned} \text{We have } a &= -\frac{1}{2}b + \frac{1}{2}d \\ b &= b \\ c &= d \\ d &= d \end{aligned}$$

so the solution in vector form is:

$$\begin{pmatrix} a \\ b \\ c \\ d \end{pmatrix} = b \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{1}{2} \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + d \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{2} \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

2.3.8.

Suppose that  $Ax=0$  has a unique solution.

Then the columns of  $A$  are linearly independent, since otherwise a nontrivial solution to  $Ax=0$  would exist, contrary to the assumption of uniqueness.

But if the columns are linearly independent, the linear transformation represented by  $A$  is injective, and therefore  $A$  has a left inverse.

(As injectivity is a sufficient condition for the existence of a left inverse.)